# The Dhāraṇī Called Mother of the Planets

Grahamātṛkā-nāma-dhāraṇī · Toh 998 · Derge Kangyur

གཟའ་རྣམས་ཀྱི་ཡུམ་ཞེས་བ་བྱའི་གཟུངས།

The Dhāraṇī Called Mother of the Planets, known in Sanskrit as the Grahamātṛkā Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as gza' rnams kyi yum zhes bya ba'i gzungs, is a dhāraṇī scripture concerned with the planetary and astral forces that were believed to shape human fortune. It opens in the great city of Aḍakavatī, where the Blessed One sits upon the vajra throne. He is praised by gods, nāgas, yakṣas and other spirits, and by the celestial bodies themselves, including the Sun, the Moon, the planets, Rāhu, the Ketus, and the twenty-eight lunar mansions. He is surrounded by an assembly of bodhisattvas headed by Vajrapāṇi and other vajra-named great beings. The text presents a protective incantation meant to pacify the influence of these heavenly bodies and to bring well-being to those who recite it. It is Toh 998 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the collection of dhāraṇī texts, the class of works devoted to powerful spoken formulas for protection and blessing.

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In the language of India: grahamātṛkānāmadhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Called Mother of the Planets.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was in the great city of Aḍakavatī. He was praised by many beings: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, mahoragas, and māras, as well as the Sun, the Moon, Mars, Venus, Jupiter, Mercury, Saturn, Rāhu, the Ketus, the twenty-eight lunar mansions, and others. Blessed by the pledge of the great vajra, he was seated upon the vajra throne.

He was surrounded and faced by a saṅgha of bodhisattvas: the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi, the bodhisattva great being Vajracaṇḍa, the bodhisattva great being Vajrasena, the bodhisattva great being Vajrapāṇi the Bow-Bearer, the bodhisattva great being Vajrapati, the bodhisattva great being Vajrālaṃkāra, the bodhisattva great being Vajraprabha, the bodhisattva great being Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva great being Samantadarśin, the bodhisattva great being Lokaśrī, the bodhisattva great being Padmaketu, the bodhisattva great being Blossoming Countenance, the bodhisattva great being Padmagarbha, the bodhisattva great being Padmanetra, the bodhisattva great being Mañjuśrī the Youthful, the bodhisattva great being Maitreya, and others. To them he taught the Dharma.

He taught the Dharma called the Jewel Ornament of the Great Array, which is virtuous in the beginning, virtuous in the middle, and virtuous in the end, excellent in meaning and excellent in its words, unadulterated, completely pure, and completely purified.

Then Vajrapāṇi looked at the assembly and rose. Through the power of his own miraculous abilities he circumambulated the Blessed One many hundreds of thousands of times, bowed down, and sat before him. With pride he crossed his legs well, looked haughtily upon the assembly, placed his palms joined in the vajra gesture at his heart, and said this to the Blessed One:

"Blessed One, the unfavorable planets, of terrible form, fierce and of fierce mind, wrathful and of wrathful form, do harm to all sentient beings and torment them. They steal their luster; some steal their wealth and food; some steal their lives; and some make long-lived beings short-lived. Because they thus injure and harm all sentient beings, I pray that the Blessed One explain the Dharma discourse by which all sentient beings will be protected."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent, that you, moved by compassion and in order to benefit all sentient beings, ask the Tathāgata about this, which is more secret even than the great secret! Therefore listen well and attentively and keep it in mind. I shall explain the offerings, the guest water, and the excellent recitations, more secret even than the secret, for the planets of terrible form, extremely wrathful and extremely terrifying.

Honored with offerings, they are honored;
When harm is done, they do harm in turn.
The colors of all these planets,
And how it is that they appear;
Of gods and of asuras,
Of kiṃnaras and of nāgas,
Of yakṣas and of rākṣasas,
Of humans and nonhumans,
Fierce ones of great splendor,
And of what pacifies the wrathful:
Their secret mantras and their offerings
I shall explain in due order."

Then from the heart of the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni himself, there spread forth rays of light called the Play of Compassion, which entered the crowns of the planets' heads. At that very instant all the planets, the Sun

and the others, rose, made offerings of divine substances to the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, bowed down, knelt, joined their palms, and said this to the Blessed One:

"The Blessed One, the Tathāgata, the Arhat, the perfectly complete Buddha, has bestowed a healing gift upon us. We pray that the Blessed One explain the Dharma discourse by which we and others will protect those who preach the Dharma, fully safeguard them, bring them peace and well-being, ward off weapons, ward off punishment, neutralize poison, destroy poison, seal the boundaries, and bind the ground."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, spoke the offerings and secret mantras of the planets:

oṃ maigholkāya svāhā
oṃ śitāṃśabe svāhā
oṃ raktāṃgakumārāya svāhā
oṃ budhāya svāhā
oṃ bṛhaspataye svāhā
oṃ alurottamāya svāhā
oṃ kṛṣṇabarṇṇaya svāhā
oṃ amṛtapriyāya svāhā
oṃ jyitiketabe svāhā

"Vajrapāṇi, these heart mantras of the secret mantras of the nine planets are accomplished by reciting them. Using incense in keeping with their colors, one should make a maṇḍala twelve finger-widths across and make offerings in its center. Having offered guest water in a vessel of earthenware, copper, or the like, or of gold or silver, one should recite each of them one hundred and eight times. Vajrapāṇi, after that one should recite seven times the secret mantra words of the dhāraṇī called Mother of the Planets. Then all the planets will provide protection. One will be freed from the graha of poverty. One whose life is exhausted will be made long-lived. Vajrapāṇi, monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, and any other kind of sentient being, and all those within whose hearing it resounds, will not meet an untimely death."

"Vajrapāṇi, one should make offerings in the center of the maṇḍala of the planets. For any preacher of the Dharma who recites it every single day, all the planets, each of them in person, will fulfill every wish. They will also dispel the poverty of those of his family."

Then the Blessed One, the Tathāgata Śākyamuni, spoke the dhāraṇī called Mother of the Planets:

"Homage to the Buddha!
Homage to Vajradhara!
Homage to Padmadhara!
Homage to the planets, who fulfill all wishes!
Homage to the lunar mansions!
Homage to the twelve signs of the zodiac!

tadyathā buddhe buddhe vajre vajre padme padme sara sara prasara prasara smara smara krīḍaya krīḍaya māraya māraya mārṅhaya mārdhaya ghāṭaya ghāṭaya sarva vighāṃ kuru kuru cchindha cchindha kṣāpaya kṣāpaya śānte śānte dānte dānte dāmaya dāmaya

Blessed Lady, please show yourself to me quickly! Please protect me together with my retinue, and all sentient beings; please protect us! Please turn back the harm of all the planets and the lunar mansions! Blessed Lady, possessor of great miraculous power, please remove hostile beings! Please dry up my wrongdoings!

caṇḍe caṇḍe turu turu caṇḍeni caṇḍeni muyu muyu mucu mucu vaha vaha ugre ugratame pūrayame manorthaṃ paripūraya sarva tathāgata adhiṣṭhite samaye svāhā oṃ svāhā hūṃ svāhā hrī svāhā dhruṃ svāhā dhriṃ svāhā padmadharāya svāhā ādityāya svāhā saumāya svāhā dhāraṇīsutāya svāhā budhāya svāhā bṛhasvataye svāhā śukrāya svāhā kṛṣṇavartṇaya svāhā rāhave svāhā ketava svāhā buddhāya svāhā vajradharāya svāhā padmadharāya sahā kumārāya svāhā sarva grahebhyaḥ svāhā sarva nakṣetrebhyaḥ svāhā sarva dādaśa rāśinibhyaḥ svāhā sarva upadravebhyaḥ svāhā oṃ sarva vidye hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ svāhā

Vajrapāṇi, these secret mantra words of the dhāraṇī called Mother of the Planets are the basis of all siddhis. Vajrapāṇi, whoever would take up these secret mantra words of the dhāraṇī of the planets should begin on the seventh day of the waxing fortnight of the last month of autumn, keeping the poṣadha observance, and until the fourteenth day should make offerings to the planets and commit the words to memory. Then, if they recite them without break throughout the day and night of the full moon, for nine years no fear of death will arise for them. They will not be endangered by the threat of the planets, by falling meteors, or by harm from the lunar mansions. They will remember their past lives. They will have made offerings to all the planets. All the planets

will grant them whatever they desire."

Then the planets bowed to the Blessed One, said, "Excellent! Excellent!" and vanished.

This concludes the dhāraṇī called Mother of the Planets.

## Translator's Notes

• The city □□□□□□□□□ is taken as Aḍakavatī, the city named in the Sanskrit Grahamātṛkā. Several bodhisattva names are reconstructed or translated with limited certainty. "Vajrapāṇi the Bow-Bearer" and "Blossoming Countenance" are literal renderings, because no secure Sanskrit form could be identified. Lokaśrī is a probable reconstruction. Here □□□□□□□□□□□□, listed among the planets, is Rāhu the eclipse demon, not the Buddha's son Rāhula. □□□□ in the planets' request is "punishment," not the philosophical term "annihilation." In Vajrapāṇi's request, □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("unfavorable planets") may be a scribal variant of □□□□□□□□ ("terrible"), which occurs a few lines later.
• "The last month of autumn" renders the Tibetan term for the third autumn month in the Tibetan calendar, corresponding roughly to Kārttika.

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## Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.